

What is Project Management?

Project Management is the discipline of planning, executing, and closing work to achieve specific goals within defined parameters such as time, budget, and resources.

The 5 Phases of Project Management

1. Initiation

- Define the project at a high level
- Identify stakeholders
- Develop a business case or project charter
- Determine feasibility

2. Planning

- Set SMART goals
- Develop scope, schedule, and budget
- Identify risks and mitigation strategies
- Create communication, resource, and quality plans

3. Execution

- Assign tasks and manage teams
- Execute the project plan
- Manage stakeholder expectations
- Ensure quality deliverables

4. Monitoring & Controlling

- Track performance (KPIs, milestones)
- Manage changes to scope, time, or cost
- Perform quality control
- Ensure alignment with the project plan

5. Closing

- Finalize deliverables and release resources
- Conduct post-mortem or lessons learned
- Gain formal acceptance
- Archive project documents

The Triple Constraint

Projects must balance the following three core constraints:

Constraint	Description	Impact
Time	Schedule for completion	Delays can lead to cost overruns and missed goals
Scope	All the work required	Scope creep can threaten schedule and budget
Cost	Budget allocated	Budget overruns may reduce profitability or quality

 **Change one, affect the others.** For example, increasing scope often requires more time and cost.

Other Key Concepts

- **Stakeholders:** Anyone impacted by the project
- **Risk Management:** Identifying and mitigating potential issues
- **Communication:** Regular, clear updates are vital
- **Quality Management:** Ensuring outputs meet expectations
- **Project Tools:** Gantt charts, Kanban boards, PM software (e.g., Asana, MS Project)

Success Tip:

A successful project delivers the agreed **scope** on **time** and within **budget**, while meeting **quality standards** and **stakeholder expectations**.